DETECT THE DWELLERS · CHAPTER DICE TEST

A paper test of one idea: **match exact numbers instead of adding them up.** Then play today's Quick Shift with the same group and compare. Tuned for **2 players**; 1–4 play the same rules.

YOU NEED

This sheet's cards. **Standard d6s in four colours:** crew dice (2 per player), 3 in a second colour for the solo crew die and agent dice, 2 amber dice for the row, and about **16 threat dice** to set under the alarm cards. Coins for HP and to mark alarms that came back.

SETUP

1. Each player picks an analyst. Start at **19 HP**.
2. Shuffle the six alarms face down. The Lockjaw Syndicate goes underneath.
3. Shuffle the 6 situations face down. Set the 3 conditions aside.
4. Shuffle the 16 items: that's the item deck. The crew draws 2.

THREAT DICE

When an alarm arrives, set threat dice **just below its card**, turned to the numbers printed along its bottom edge. Those dice are its hits. Each alarm's numbers bunch round one main number, so a double on that number goes a long way. **4 players:** add the card's **+** die (a 6). Solo to 3 players use the printed dice.

Card  +  per player past 3

1–3 players set  · 4 players 

A FLIP

1. Pick who's on point. From the second flip on, flip a **situation** first and play it.
2. Flip the top alarm and set its dice. On point may **baseline it** (below). If anything is on the row, roll the row: every row alarm that comes back returns with its printed dice, and the two with the highest Damage hit everyone on the way in. Two or more in play: a **multi-alarm** fight.
3. Fight. When the feed is empty, the boss arrives with one last row roll and no arrival hits.

THE ROW

Roll the **2 amber dice** and add them. A row alarm comes back if the sum is **at most its number** ("back on 2–5" comes back on 5 or less). The first time an alarm comes back, put a coin on it. It stays.

BASELINE IT

A newly flipped alarm (never a comeback) can be baselined: set the 4 dice on its **Baseline** line too (+1 per player past 3). Beat it with them all and the agents have learned it: tuck it under an agent someone holds. That agent gains the alarm's Baseline line until it is discarded. No agents: it waits for the next one drawn. The alarm still goes on the row.

A FIGHT ROUND

1. **Row.** From the second round on, roll the row first.
2. **Roll.** Everyone rolls one crew die. On point rolls two. Solo: two of your own dice plus the crew die (second colour). Each Triage Agent rolls an agent die (second colour) for whoever holds it. **Once a round, each player may reroll one of their own dice** before using it.
3. **Match.** A die takes out one threat die showing **exactly** its number: a  takes a  . Turn the taken die aside.
4. **Hits back.** Every alarm with dice left hits everyone who isn't blocking, for its Damage. An alarm with no dice left is beaten.

DOUBLES

Your analyst card shows your doubles. Every other die (the solo crew die, agent dice): **only a 6**. A double **counts as two dice showing its number**: a Hunter's  takes two  s, under one alarm or two. **Or** it guards: you block this round. Never both. Agent dice can't guard or hit the boss.

AFTER A FIGHT

Beaten alarms go back on the row, **every time**: nothing removes them for good. Draw 2 items (1 solo) and decide who takes each. **Agents** are passive and work for whoever holds them: 2 each (the Soarcerer 3; solo 4). Full? Discard one to take another. **Consumables** don't take a slot: keep them in hand and use each once.

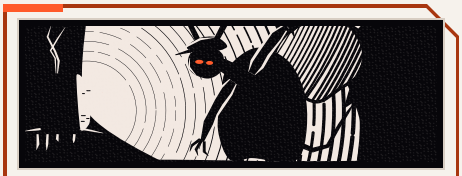
SITUATIONS AND CONDITIONS

Most situations make you choose: stay or run, grab it or leave it. On point rolls any grab with spare dice. Conditions are cards you keep in front of you. **Rattled** and **Exposed** wear off; **Focused** waits until you use it. Nobody holds two of the same.

WIN OR LOSE

Beat the boss and you've survived the night. Anyone at 0 HP and the shift is lost.

Prototype only. Numbers from the bot sim of 2026-10-31, exact numbers with situations and baselining (prototypes/chapter-dice/README.md). Record: who played, time, win or loss, and every rule you played wrong.



IDENTITY — BACK ON 2–5

MAILER DAEMON

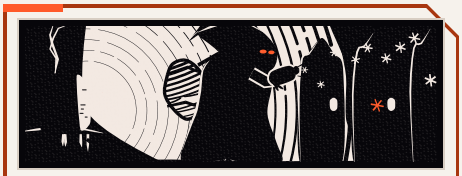
DAMAGE 1

BEACON. Roll the row when it arrives or comes back.

MAILER-DAEMON says your message bounced. Click here to retry. You never sent one.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
The highest-Damage alarm deals 1 less.



IDENTITY — BACK ON 2–5

PASSWORD SPRAYER

DAMAGE 1

PIERCING. Blocks don't stop it.

Summer2026! tries every account in the tower, one a minute. It only needs one to work.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
Once a round, reroll one more die.



CLOUD — BACK ON 2–3

OAUTH CONSENT GRIFTER

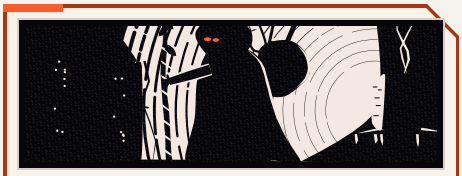
DAMAGE 3

TARGETED. Only on point takes its damage, doubled.

A friendly pop-up asks if this app may read all your mail. Someone's thumb is already on Accept.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
On point rolls one more die.



ENDPOINT — BACK ON 2–4

LIVING-OFF-THE-LAND SCAVENGER

DAMAGE 3

EVASIVE. Only a double can hit it. A double of another number takes out one die.

Rundll32, mshta, certutil: every tool it runs is yours. It lives off what already grows here.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
Comebacks don't hit on arrival.



NETWORK — BACK ON 2–3

EXFIL COURIER

DAMAGE 4

ESCALATING. +1 Damage every round it stays up.

rclone.exe is moving 40 GB to a cloud bucket you've never seen. It's still small. For now.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
Add 1 to every row roll.



ENDPOINT — BACK ON 2–3

ROOTKIT IMPLANT

DAMAGE 4

REGEN. At the end of each round, put back one die it lost.

You count the svchost.exe processes twice. One looks exactly right, and it has teeth.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
After every won fight, heal 5 split across the crew.



BOSS — ARRIVES AT 05:59

THE LOCKJAW SYNDICATE

DAMAGE 9

DOUBLE EXTORTION. +2 Damage until it has lost two dice. Agent dice can't hit it.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

REFERENCE — EVERY DIE

DICE

takes out a exactly

double takes anywhere

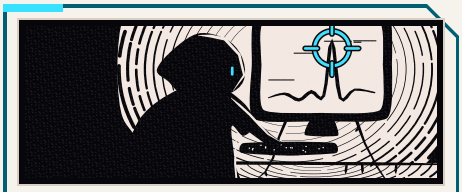
A double counts as **two** dice showing its number, **or** guards. Never both.

Your doubles are on your analyst card. Crew and agent dice: only a is a double.

Once a round, reroll one of your own dice.

4 players: add the card's + die.

Row: 2 amber dice; a row alarm comes back if the sum is at most its number.



ANALYST — STANDARD D6

HUNTER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

Your 1s match any number on any alarm.



ANALYST STANDARD D6

RESPONDER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

Once a fight, after you roll, pick an alarm: it deals no damage this round.



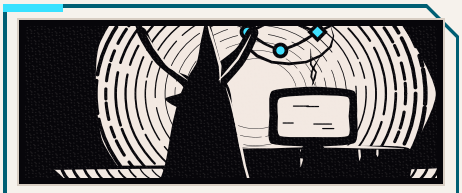
ANALYST STANDARD D6

ENGINEER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

Once a round, turn one of your dice to its opposite side (1↔6, 2↔5, 3↔4). It counts as one die.



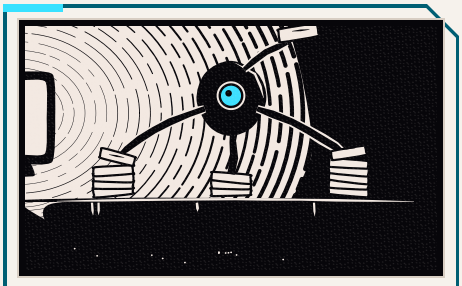
ANALYST STANDARD D6

SOARCERER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

You hold one more agent: 3 (solo 5).

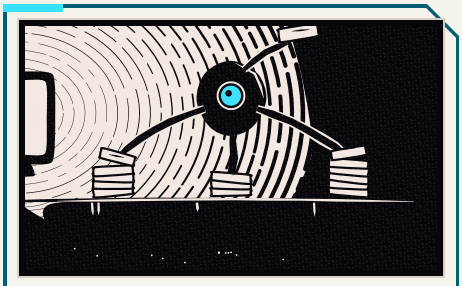


AGENT PASSIVE

TRIAGE AGENT

WHILE YOU HOLD IT

Roll an agent die with your dice every round.

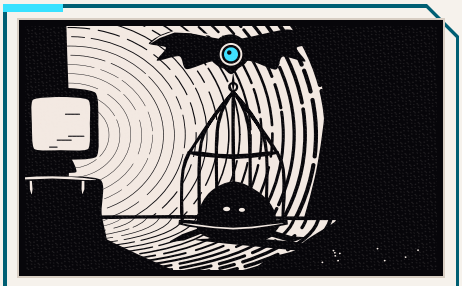


AGENT PASSIVE

TRIAGE AGENT

WHILE YOU HOLD IT

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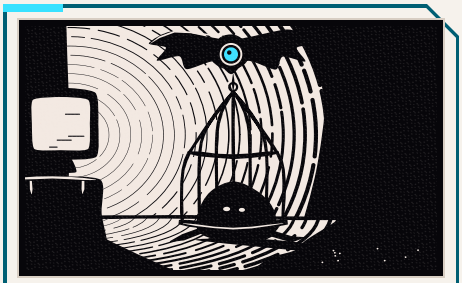


AGENT PASSIVE

CONTAINMENT AGENT

WHILE YOU HOLD IT

Your biggest hitter deals you 2 less, never below 1.

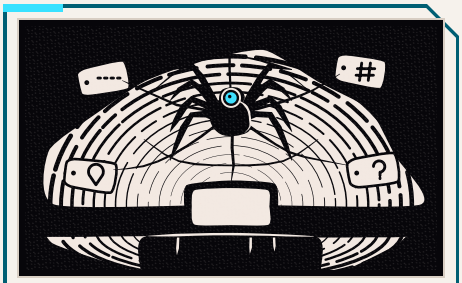


AGENT PASSIVE

CONTAINMENT AGENT

WHILE YOU HOLD IT

Your biggest hitter deals you 2 less, never below 1.

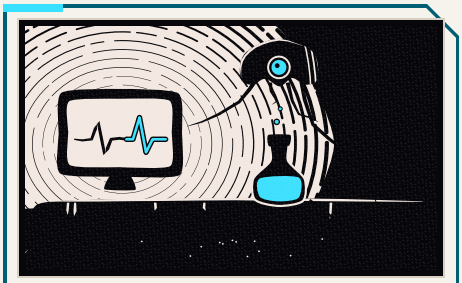


AGENT PASSIVE

ENRICHMENT AGENT

WHILE YOU HOLD IT

Once a round, turn one of your dice to any number.

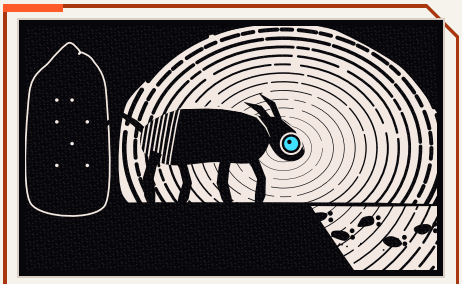


AGENT PASSIVE

RECOVERY AGENT

WHILE YOU HOLD IT

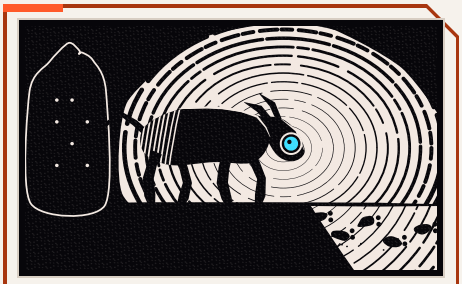
After every won fight, heal 4 HP.



CONSUMABLE USE ONCE

SURGE PLAYBOOK

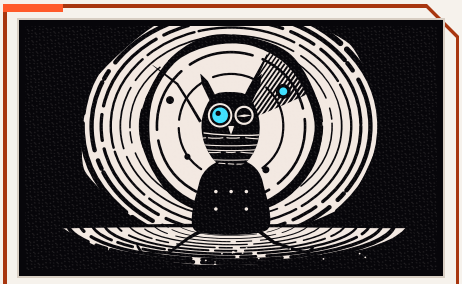
USE IT
After the roll: roll 3 more dice.



CONSUMABLE USE ONCE

SURGE PLAYBOOK

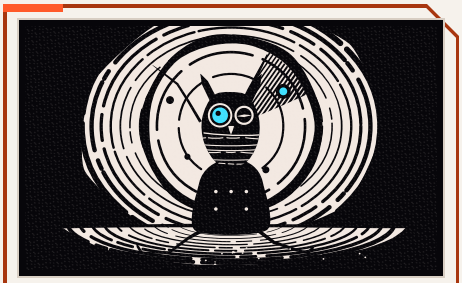
USE IT
After the roll: roll 3 more dice.



CONSUMABLE USE ONCE

THREAT INTEL FEED

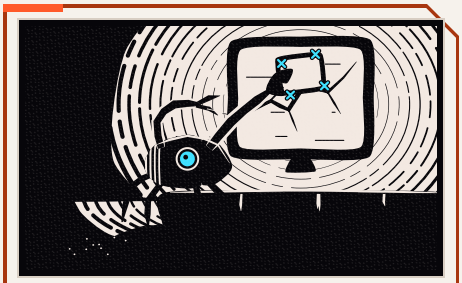
USE IT
After the roll: every die matches anything this round.



CONSUMABLE USE ONCE

THREAT INTEL FEED

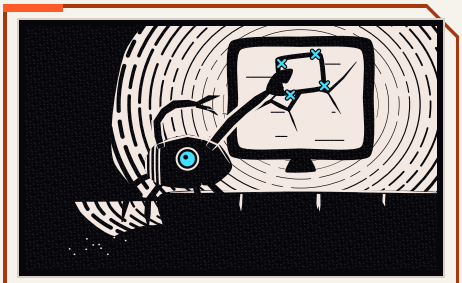
USE IT
After the roll: every die matches anything this round.



CONSUMABLE USE ONCE

ISOLATION SCRIPT

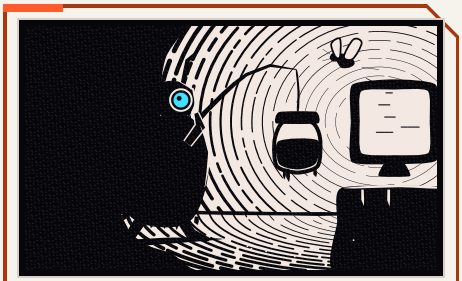
USE IT
Remove one die from every alarm (the boss keeps at least one).



CONSUMABLE USE ONCE

ISOLATION SCRIPT

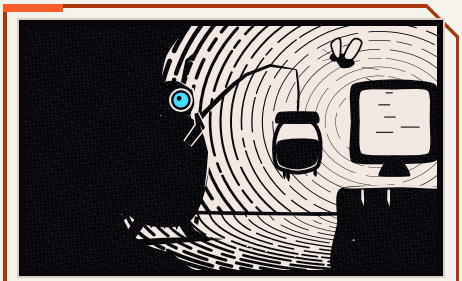
USE IT
Remove one die from every alarm (the boss keeps at least one).



CONSUMABLE USE ONCE

SHIFT COFFEE

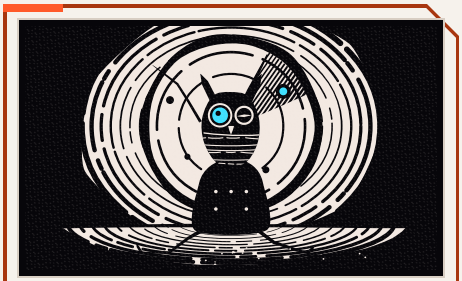
USE IT
Heal 6 HP split across the crew.



CONSUMABLE USE ONCE

SHIFT COFFEE

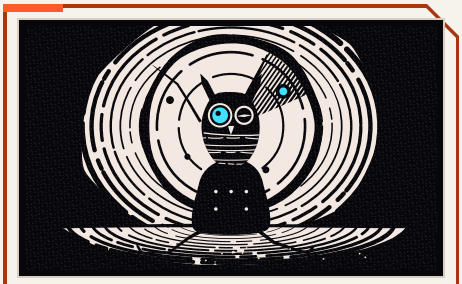
USE IT
Heal 6 HP split across the crew.



CONSUMABLE USE ONCE

CHANGE FREEZE

USE IT
Skip the next row roll.



CONSUMABLE — USE ONCE

CHANGE FREEZE

USE IT
Skip the next row roll.



STAY OR RUN — SITUATION

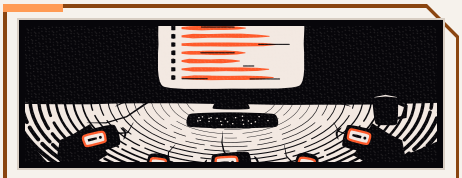
THE BADGE THAT WASN'T

A badge swipes into the server room at 03:10. Its owner left on Friday. You're on point: find out who's holding it.

Turn the top alarm face up, then choose.

HOLD THE ROOM
On point takes Exposed. Win the fight: draw an item.

FALL BACK
It hits everyone once and goes on the row unfought. Not the boss.



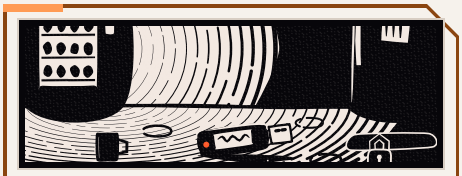
STAY OR RUN — SITUATION

PAGER STORM

Four hundred alerts land in four minutes, and every phone on the floor goes off. Everyone is awake now.

RIDE IT OUT
Everyone loses 2 HP.

MUTE IT
The next alarm sets one more threat die: a ⚅.



GRAB — SITUATION

THE JANITOR'S USB

A USB stick sits on the break-room table, labelled SALARIES 2026. Three people have already plugged it in.

GRAB IT
On point rolls 3 dice. Any pair: draw 2 items and take Focused. No pair: take Rattled.

LEAVE IT
Nothing happens.



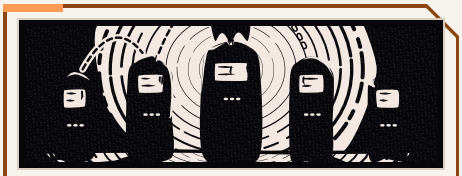
GRAB — SITUATION

DARK WEB CHATTER

Your company's name turns up on a forum at 02:30, next to a price. Someone is selling a way in.

DIG IN
On point picks 1–4 dice and rolls them. Any ⚅: draw 2 items. None: lose 1 HP per die.

LET IT GO
Nothing happens.

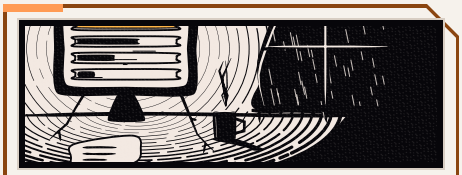


EVENT — SITUATION

LATERAL WHISPERS

Logons hop from host to host, one every ninety seconds. Something you beat is looking for a way back in.

Roll the row now. Anything that comes back hits on arrival and joins the next fight.



CHOICE — SITUATION

PATCH TUESDAY

The patches deploy and the tower goes quiet. You get a window. Use it.

TAKE A BREATHER
Everyone heals 2 HP.

RAID THE SUPPLY CLOSET
Draw an item.

CONDITION — BAD

RATTLED

Your next roll has no doubles. Then discard this.

CONDITION — BAD

EXPOSED

Your next fight: each round anything hits you, take 1 more. Discard this after the fight.

CONDITION

KEEP IT

FOCUSED

Once, after you roll, turn one of your dice to any number. Then discard this.